

Meiling Wu

Paul Merage School of Business
University of California, Irvine
Operations and Decision Technologies
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EDUCATION

Ph.D., Operations and Decision Technologies, *University of California, Irvine* Expected June 2027
Paul Merage School of Business
Dissertation: Whom to Admit and When: University Admission Decisions with Uncertainty
Committee: John Turner, Ken Murphy, Jingyuan Hu

M.S., Supply Chain Management, *Olin Business School, Washington University in St. Louis* January 2021

B.S., Logistics Management, *Tianjin Normal University, China* June 2017

RESEARCH INTERESTS

Sequential decision-making under uncertainty; stochastic optimization; data-driven operations; capacity allocation.
Applications: higher education admissions and enrollment management; supply chain management; healthcare operations.

RESEARCH

WORKING PAPERS

- “Admit Now or Later? Dynamic Admission Control under Non-stationary Arrivals,” with John Turner.
- “A Simulation-Based Comparison of Graduate Admissions Policies,” with Ken Murphy.

AWARDS

- Ray Watson Doctoral Fellowship, University of California, Irvine 2024

CONFERENCE TALKS

- “Admit Now or Later? Dynamic Admission Control under Non-stationary Arrivals”
 - INFORMS Annual Meeting 2024, 2025, scheduled 2026
 - Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference 2025, scheduled 2026

PROFESSIONAL SERVICE

- Session Chair, Decision Sciences Institute Annual Conference 2025
- Vice President, Olin Supply Chain & Operations Association 2020–2021
 - Built partnerships with Bayer and Budweiser; organized practitioner panels and laboratory visits.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Teaching Assistant and Review Session Leader, University of California, Irvine

2022–2026

Paul Merage School of Business

- Five years of student-facing teaching experience across more than 25 course offerings.
- Supported undergraduate, MSBA, MBA, and Executive MBA students.

SELECTED COURSES

- **Operations Excellence (Executive MBA)** Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026
 - Led structured reviews that connected quantitative models with managerial decisions.
 - Used worked examples and software demonstrations to strengthen analytical confidence.
- **Predictive Analytics (MSBA)** Winter 2023; Winter, Spring, Fall 2024; Spring, Fall 2025; Spring, Fall 2026
 - Emphasized interpretable benchmarks, feature selection, overfitting, and business implications.
- **Management Science** Winter, Spring, Summer 2022–2025; Winter 2026
 - Developed step-by-step explanations of optimization model formulation, Excel Solver, and simulations.
- **Statistics for Data Science** Summer 2026
 - Supported statistical reasoning, hypothesis analysis, and interpretation through review sessions.

TEACHING INTERESTS

Management science; project management; operations management; supply chain management; business analytics; business statistics; predictive and prescriptive analytics; SQL; Python/R; AI applications in business.

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

University Admissions Decision Support, Doctoral Research, University of California, Irvine

2023–Present

Predict-Then-Optimize Dynamic Admission Control — with John Turner

- Formulate sequential admissions as a stochastic dynamic program that jointly determines applicant selection and offer timing under nonstationary arrivals and uncertain enrollment.
- Incorporate deposit observations and waitlist decisions into the system state to study trade-offs among early admission, waiting, enrollment targets, and cohort quality.
- Forecast applicant deposit and enrollment behaviors using XGBoost, increasing true positives by 27%.
- Solve small-scale instances exactly to characterize optimal admission decisions and assess the value of deposit information and decision flexibility.

Simulation-Based Policy Evaluation — with Kenneth E. Murphy

- Design fixed and dynamic GPA threshold rules that adjust selectivity across rounds to meet cumulative expected enrollment targets, using overall and subgroup yield estimates.
- Compare enrollment and cohort GPA with current practice and a full-information benchmark, assessing transparent rules that administrators can interpret and implement.

Research Assistant, Longitudinal Genomic and Clinical Data, UC Irvine

May–Dec 2022

Advisor: Annie Qu

- Analyzed 1,879 DNA methylation biomarkers across four time points for 526 subjects using R.
- Examined longitudinal patterns and missing data in a study of PTSD outcomes.

Agricultural Supply Chain Optimization, Washington University in St. Louis

2021–2022

Advisor: Salih Tutun

- Forecast daily site-level temperatures with LSTM, SARIMA, and gradient boosting models, evaluated by RMSE.
 - Built a mixed-integer planting cost minimization model that scheduled 1,375 seed populations under a weekly storage-capacity limit of 7,000 units to keep weekly harvests consistent.
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Research Assistant, Hospital Operations during COVID-19, Boston University

Mar–Jul 2021

Advisor: Joseph Restuccia

Investigated operational challenges hospitals faced during the COVID-19 pandemic, including sudden surges in patient volume and pressure on beds, staffing, and medical supplies.

Research Assistant, Determinants of Corporate Logistics Costs, Nankai University

Jan–Jul 2016

Advisor: Xiaomei Jiang

- Compiled accounting data for 1,360 local companies and classified them into high-, medium-, and low-logistics-cost groups.
- Applied naïve Bayes classification with a training/testing split, then used dummy encoding and group lasso to identify 13 interpretable cost drivers, such as administrative, selling, and general expenses.

CONSULTING AND INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

Team Lead, Fit & Food Connection, Olin Business Consulting Project

Fall 2020

- Led a four-person team to analyze volunteer attrition and redesign onboarding and workload processes.
- Reduced onboarding from two weeks to three days; average volunteer attendance increased by 41%.

Consultant Intern, HybridHelix Consulting LLC

Summer 2020

- Developed lead-response prediction models and consolidated CRM data for segmentation and analysis.

Consulting Project, Edward Jones, Olin Business School

Spring 2020

- Evaluated accounting-process automation and built scenario-based return-on-investment models.

Supply Chain Cross-Department Specialist, Original Life Fresh Food E-Commerce, Beijing

Apr 2017–Feb 2019

- Proposed using offline stores as distribution centers and selected sites by analyzing customer demographics and order data, shortening delivery distances, lowering cold-chain logistics costs, and preserving product quality.
- Built visual sales reports from the ERP system covering 1,000+ products at hourly, daily, and weekly levels to track revenue targets and optimize SKU assortment.
- Managed warehouse layout, product cataloging, route planning, and shipment processing; maintained performance metrics to identify and implement improvements.

REFERENCES

John Turner**Associate Professor**

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Ken Murphy**Assistant Professor of Teaching**

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